



How to Start Writing with DITA?

Choose a DITA XML editor

Choose a DITA XML editor of choice.

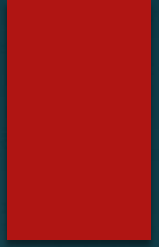
Sample DITA XML editing tools:

- ▶ Oxygen XML Author
- ▶ Adobe FrameMaker
- ▶ SDL
- ▶ IXIASOFT DITA CCMS
- ▶ easyDITA



In this course, we shall use Oxygen XML Author
[HTTPS://WWW.OXYGENXML.COM](https://www.oxygenxml.com)

Install the Oxygen XML Author



1. Request a trial license from the Get a Trial page:
https://www.oxygenxml.com/xml_author/register.html?p=author
2. Start the download. Go to
https://www.oxygenxml.com/xml_author/download_oxygenxml_author.html
3. Choose your OS.
4. Click on the *Download* button.
5. Once the download is complete, start the installation wizard and install the tool.
6. Once the installation is complete, enter your trial license key.
You are now ready with the set up of the software for this course.

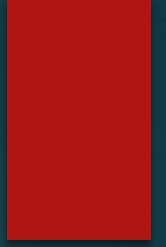
Note: If your trial expires before you manage to complete the course, you can contact jordan.stanchev@ipdocu.com to ask for a trial extension.



5 Quick Steps to DITA

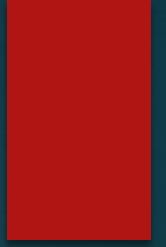
HOW TO START WRITING?

Steps to Take



1. Create a DITA map.
2. Choose appropriate DITA topic type.
3. Create the DITA topic.
4. Reference the topic from your map.
5. Transform the DITA XML into desired deliverable output format.

A Quick Demo...



1. Create a DITA map.
2. Choose appropriate DITA topic type.
3. Create the DITA topic.
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Step 1: Create a DITA Map

DITA Maps

- ▶ What is a DITA map and why do I need one?
- ▶ Which are the common DITA map element I should know and use?
- ▶ Demo
- ▶ Exercise

What is DITA Map?

DITA maps are documents that organize topics and other resources into structured collections of information. DITA maps specify hierarchy and the relationships among the topics; they also provide the context in which keys are defined and resolved.*

* Definition from the DITA Specification

These are some more DITA topics you have written.



This is a single DITA topic you have written.

Q: How do you deliver these topics into your User Guide?!



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Answer:

You need a vehicle that will carry the topics you want and allow you to organize them the way you want it.

Just like a bag or a table, you use the DITA map to do so.



Q: What happens to a topic that is not referenced by a Map?



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Answer:

It's left out! It is not treated as a part of your deliverable.

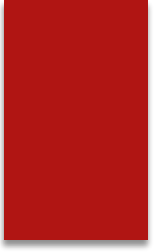
Only DITA topics that are referenced by a DITA shall be delivered!



Let's Create a
Map!

DITA Maps: Exercise

Create a DITA map

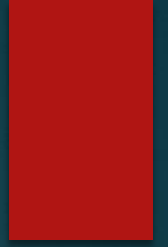


Step 2: Choose Appropriate DITA Topic Type

DITA Topics

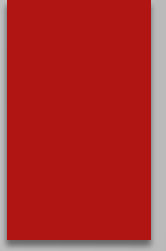
- ▶ What is DITA topic?
- ▶ Which types of DITA topics you can use?

Choose the Appropriate Topic Type



- ▶ Task
- ▶ Concept
- ▶ Reference

Choose the Appropriate Topic Type



- ▶ Task
- ▶ Concept
- ▶ Reference

Step 3: Create a DITA Topic



Let's Write
Documentation!

Write a Sample Instruction

To use the calculator app, you need to unlock your phone first.

You can use a calculator app on your smartphone. You will find it useful, when you need to quickly calculate some numbers.

To start the application:

- 1. Navigate to the Calculator application icon.*
- 2. Tap the icon.
The application starts.*

You are now ready to calculate with it.

For example, if you have purchased a book for 5\$ and you have given 10\$, how much change should you expect? Answer is $10-5=5$ \$ change.

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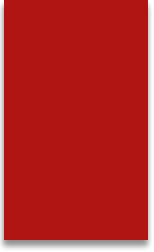
Context

Steps

Result

Example

TASK



Step 4: Reference the Topic From the Map



DITA Map Elements

WHICH ARE THE FREQUENTLY USED DITA MAP ELEMENTS?

Map - DITA Map Elements

<map>

Allows you to define a map.

You need to the map to define what goes in your deliverable and which metadata is relevant for it.

Without a map, you have no documentation deliverable.

Map = your documentation content

Topicref – DITA Map Elements

<topicref>

Allows you to reference a topic from the map.

You can nest topicref elements to create hierarchical structures in your documentation.

Map + topicref + topic = your documentation structure

Topichead – DITA Map Elements

<topichead>

Allows you to create a single title in your documentation structure (without content).

For example, a title of a book section can be created using topichead.

Map + topichead = Just a title in your documentation structure

To find the full list of map elements supported in Oxygen XML Author, see
<https://www.oxygenxml.com/dita/1.3/specs/archSpec/base/ditamap-elements.html>

The Complete List of Supported DITA Map Elements

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DITA map elements

A DITA map describes the relationships among a set of DITA topics. The DITA map and map-group domain elements organize topics into hierarchies, groups, and relationships; they also define keys.

A DITA map is composed of the following elements:

`<map>`

The `<map>` element is the root element of the DITA map.

`<topicref>`

The `<topicref>` elements are the basic elements of a map. A `<topicref>` element can reference a DITA topic, a DITA map, or a non-DITA resource. A `<topicref>` element also can have a title, short description, and the same kind of prolog-level metadata that is available in topics.

The `<topicref>` elements can be nested to create a hierarchy, which can be used to define a table of contents (TOC) for print output, online navigation, and parent/child links.

Hierarchies can be annotated using the `@collection-type` attribute to define a particular type of relationship, such as a set of choices, a sequence, or a family. These collection types can affect link generation, and they might be interpreted differently for different outputs.

`<reltable>`

Relationship tables are defined with the `<reltable>` element. Relationship tables can be used to define relationships among DITA topics or among DITA topics and non-DITA resources. In a relationship table, the columns define common attributes, metadata, or information types (for example, task or troubleshooting) for the resources that are referenced in that column. The rows define relationships between the resources in different cells of the same row.

The `<relrow>`, `<relcell>`, `<relheaders>`, and `<relcolspec>` elements are used to define the components of the relationship table. Relationships defined in the relationship table also can be further refined by using the `@collection-type` attribute.

`<topicgroup>`

The `<topicgroup>` element defines a group or collection outside of a hierarchy or relationship table. It is a convenience element that is equivalent to a `<topicref>` element without an `@href` attribute or navigation title. Groups can be combined with hierarchies and relationship tables, for example, by including a `<topicgroup>` element within a set of siblings in a hierarchy or within a table cell. The `<topicref>` elements so grouped can then share inherited attributes and linking relationships with no effect on the navigation or table of contents.

`<topicmeta>`

Most map-level elements, including the map itself, can contain metadata inside the `<topicmeta>` element. Metadata typically is applied to an element and its descendants.

`<ux-window>`

The `<ux-window>` element enables authors to define windowing information for the display of output topics that are appropriate to the delivery platform. Window management is important in user assistance and help system outputs, as well as for other hypertext and electronic delivery modes.

`<topichead>`

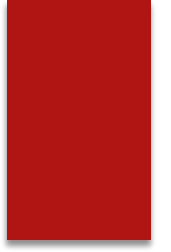
The `<topichead>` element provides a navigation title; it is a convenience element that is equivalent to a `<topicref>` element with a navigation title but no associated resource.

`<anchor>`

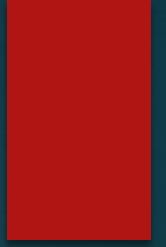
The `<anchor>` element provides an integration point that another map can reference in order to insert its navigation into the referenced map's navigation tree. For those familiar with Eclipse help systems, this serves the same purpose as the `<anchor>` element in that system. It might not be supported for all output formats.

`<navref>`

Step 5: Transform the Map into Desired Output Format



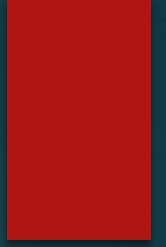
Output Production in DITA



- ▶ Understanding single-sourcing in DITA.
- ▶ Understanding output configuration options.

Let's Create
an Output!

Output Production: DEMO



- ▶ How to produce a PDF file from a DITA map?